

Like any entrepreneur who starts a business, he was holding on too tight. They have been doing proprietary trading for 25 years and have never had a losing year. Despite that track record, they have missed the entire growth in asset management. They have had no hedge fund business through the entire hedge fund era. He was getting too old to take risks, and he admitted it himself. In the end, I agreed to become a managing member of First New York Securities. The firm is very inefficiently run and has no technology. We need to make it more efficient and bring it into the twenty-first century. We need to start managing outside money and create a more valuable business. That is the plan.

What are your long-term goals?

I am still waiting to figure out what it is I want to do when I grow up. I am still waiting for the revelation. In some ways, it is quite depressing.

I don't understand. You have been very successful.

But what have I achieved? I haven't built anything.

How do you measure success? If it's monetary, by any reasonable definition, you have been more than successful. If it is building a business, again by any reasonable definition, you have been successful. You are not going to invent a cure for cancer. If you want to impact the world, I guess you could give money away.

I give money away; that's what I do. I am still here because I couldn't figure out anything better to do at the time. It still feels like I'm waiting to work out what I should be doing.

Don't you feel that trading is what you were born to do?

Well, no. I have a view—and maybe it's a bit egotistical—that I can do anything I want to do. I'll go to the city to get a job as a trader. I will build a house. I'll take on a bank in litigation. I'll start a hedge fund.

If that's your perspective, then do whatever you want to do.

That's the problem.

You don't know what you want to do?

No. I can tell you that running a fund doesn't make me happy. I enjoy it, but I used to enjoy it a lot more than I do now.